

itation data, an itinerary manager, a tip calculator for restaurants—which lists tax and tip information for over 30 countries and across seven service categories from restaurants to taxis, currency exchange, unit converter, a comprehensive area code directory, packing list, and more. WorldMate comes with an optional desktop client for data syncing and data delivery to your PC as well as mobile devices.

WorldMate 2005 Professional is available for all platforms. Download an evaluation copy from www.mobimate.com.

Keeping In Touch

Agile Messenger for Symbian

VeriChat for PalmOS

MSN Messenger for Windows Mobile

If you own a smartphone or PDA with wireless radio, there are several utilities that allow you to stay in touch with your important contacts over your favourite instant messengers (IMs). Instant messaging over a phone can be a lot cheaper than SMS messages, and is ideal for arranging an impromptu meet over coffee or lunch.

We take a look at VeriChat for the Palm OS and Agile Messenger for the Symbian platform. Users of Windows Mobile platform already have the able MSN Messenger installed.

Agile Messenger allows you to connect simultaneously to Yahoo!, MSN, ICQ, and AOL. It can download your contacts to a Symbian mobile device. Agile can connect to the relevant servers either via your phone's GPRS connection, or by wirelessly connecting to your PC and using its Internet connection via Bluetooth. Note that the software is also available for Windows Mobile and Palm OS, but it is not as developed as the Symbian version. Head to www.agilemobile.com to download Agile Messenger.

VeriChat is a similar tool for the Palm OS platform. It is an always-on, unified IM application for PalmOS devices. On a smartphone, such as the Treo 600, VeriChat works with your persistent GPRS /CDMA 1xRTT wireless data connection to give you an always-on presence on the Yahoo!, ICQ, MSN, and AOL chat networks. It can also send across messages as SMS data. Your buddies always see you as online and can send you messages even when your device is in standby mode, and you can receive and reply to these messages. On a non-phone PDA, such as a Tungsten C with its Wi-Fi connection, you can use VeriChat whenever you have a network connection, or you can use it in always-on mode in conjunction with your mobile phone.

VeriChat offers advanced features such as auto-login/logout, which lets you pick the time of day when you want to be available on the IM networks. You can download a trial version of VeriChat from www.iambic.com. VeriChat is also available for the Symbian and Windows Mobile platforms.

Manage Your Personal Data

Agendus for Palm OS and Symbian

Pocket Informant 2005 for Windows Mobile

Chances are you bought the approximately \$500 device now sitting in your pocket, to do at least some form of personal information management (PIM): to maintain a list of contacts with phone numbers and important dates perhaps?

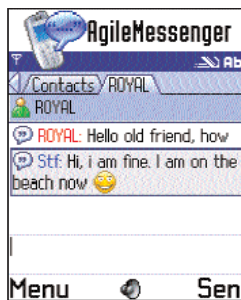


Pocket Informant

Maybe you needed a comprehensive calendar application on the go. Maybe you needed something to keep track and make sense of your mountain of tasks. Whatever the need, a PIM is an essential tool on any mobile handset. And while most devices ship with some form of rudimentary PIM application, you can always find something more comprehensive online. We take a look at one such application meant for Palm OS and Symbian platforms. For Windows Mobile devices, we suggest Pocket Informant.

The personal information manager called Agendus tightly integrates three of the most-used applications on your mobile device: contacts, calendar, and tasks, letting you seamlessly link your business contacts and friends to meetings, events, calls, and tasks. Salespeople will love the way it generates a comprehensive contact history. And, you can choose from seven daily, weekly, and monthly calendar views so you can see your schedule the way you like it. You can even assign icons to events for some fun customisation, so you can tell what upcoming events are with just a glance, in any view. Agendus is available for both the Palm OS and the Symbian platforms. You can download a trial version from www.iambic.com.

While Windows Mobile devices have a healthy application suite for personal information management, we suggest you at least try Pocket Informant. It is a tightly-integrated application that replaces your inbuilt Contacts, Calendar and Tasks applications with simple yet more powerful versions. The program can sync with Outlook and ActiveSync, and any third-party sync solutions. Some of the advanced features of the product allow you to create templates for appointments or tasks, with contact info automatically embedded in the subject, location, or notes. The application also offers smart journaling options and support for VGA resolution and landscape orientation. You can download a trial version of Pocket Informant at www.pocketinformant.com.



Instant Messengers

Lock Your Personal Data

SplashID for Palm OS, Symbian and Windows Mobile

The concept of using your mobile handset as an electronic wallet has been bandied about with much fanfare. Although we still haven't reached the point where we can shop and flash our cell phone to make the credit transfer, these mobile devices can nevertheless carry a lot of personal information. With the threat of wireless snooping, viruses and Trojans ever-present, it becomes vital to protect personal data to the best of our ability.

There's an application for all major mobile platforms that does just that. Called SplashID, the utility safely and securely stores all your personal identification information, including usernames, passwords, credit card numbers, calling cards, bank accounts, and PINs. Information is stored in a secure, encrypted format, and is quickly accessible on the mobile handset or even the desktop computer via the included desktop software.

SplashID offers an unlimited number of customisable record types and categories for storing all kinds of personal information. You can also use it to beam stored records to other devices. The software uses Blowfish encryption to protect your data. It offers field masking, an automatic